

Markscheme

Mathematics: analysis and approaches

Practice question bank

14. (a)

Consider the function $f(x) = \frac{3x + 4}{(x - 2)(x + 3)}$.

Write $f(x)$ as the sum of partial fractions in the form $\frac{A}{x - 2} + \frac{B}{x + 3}$.

$$3x + 4 = A(x + 3) + B(x - 2) \quad (M1)$$

$$\text{substituting } x = 2: 10 = 5A \Rightarrow A = 2 \quad \mathbf{A1}$$

$$\text{substituting } x = -3: -5 = -5B \Rightarrow B = 1 \quad \mathbf{A1}$$

[3 marks]